

POWER

Named after an old microprocessor instruction set designed by IBM in the late 1980's, POWER stands for Performance Optimisation With Enhanced RISC. It was designed and manufactured by a number of companies including IBM, LSI and e2v in 1990's. There exists a governing body called Power.org, which consists of more than 40 companies and organisations to regulate licenses and trademarks of the Power architecture.

IBM came out with the first generation of POWER ISA from which the POWER PC instruction set was derived later. The term 'Power architecture' includes all generations of chips based on the POWER IBM architecture and the PowerPC processors.

The Power architecture chips were behind all the 7th generation consoles including the PlayStation 3 and the Xbox 360. The chips were also at the heart of many supercomputers. The TOP500 list of supercomputers in June showed that at least 22 of the top 50 fastest supercomputers in the world used Power chips somewhere in their design

IBM came out with its latest generation of processors based on the POWER architecture called the IBM POWER8, designed specifically for today's computing world of big data and cloud computing. The multi-threaded chip comes in 4, 6, 8, 10 and 12 core variants, where each core can



POWER architecture has been used in building almost everything, from gaming consoles to supercomputers.